



▲ AIR CLEANERS

The trachea is lined with sticky mucus that traps dirt and germs in the incoming air. Tiny cilia (green) move the dirty mucus to the throat, where it is swallowed.

Air is carried to and from the lungs by the trachea.

Curved ribs form a protective cage around the lungs.

The airways become more finely branched as they penetrate deeper into the lung.

The heart pumps blood to the lungs to pick up oxygen.

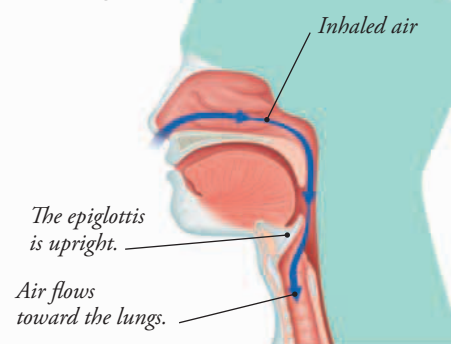
Protective membranes cover the lungs.

A sheet of muscle called the diaphragm helps inflate the lungs.

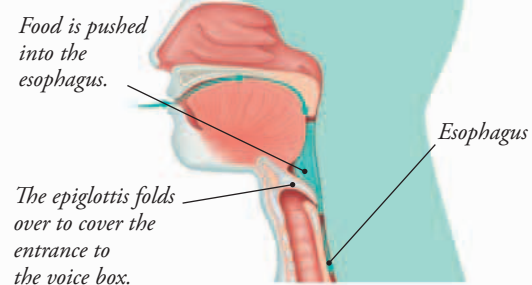
NO CHOKING

Every time you swallow food or drink, your breathing stops. A flap of tissue called the epiglottis drops over the entrance to your voice box to stop food from getting into the airway to your lungs and making you choke. If this happens, however, coughing forces food out of the airway and back into your throat.

Breathing



Swallowing



WOW!

Every day, you swallow about a glassful of slimy mucus produced by your airways.

